



ANNUAL GENERAL MEETING AGENDA

February 7, 2025, 6:00 PM, FIP 204

1. Call to order

Acknowledgement of Territory

We would like to acknowledge that we are on the unceded territory of the Okanagan Nation. That's to say, the city we know as Kelowna sits on land that was stolen from the Sylix people—people who still inhabit it. Territorial acknowledgements accomplish very little, except to make settlers feel uncomfortable with the ongoing atrocities committed against Indigenous people in Canada—our neighbours, and the people who have taken care of this land long before we arrived. This is indeed something we should feel uncomfortable with and keep in mind as we live, work and learn on the land of the Okanagan Nation.

2. Adoption of Agenda and Review of Membership

2025-02-07.01

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Be it resolved that Secretary Miles DeBoer serve as the meeting chair.

2025-02-07.02

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Be it resolved that the agenda be adopted.

3. Presentation of the Resolution Package (see attachment)

Presented by President Nat Scott.

4. Approval of the Previous Year's Financial Statement

2025-02-07.04

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Be it resolved that the previous year's financial statement be approved as presented.

5. President's Report of the Course Union's Activities

Presented by President Nat Scott

6. Presentation of the Annual Operating Budget

Presented by President Nat Scott

7. Question Period

8. Adjournment

2025-02-07.05

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Be it resolved that the meeting adjourn.

2025 CSCU AGM Resolution Package

Preface

This non-normative section is meant to give some context on the resolutions and bylaws we're putting forth in this package. Robert's Rules of Order—the system we're expected to use in our annual general meetings to make decisions—is a powerful tool for making people feel powerless, and our hope here is to make what we're trying to accomplish more accessible.

The CSCU is a course union, which means that we're run democratically. You get to vote for us, the members of the Executive Council, at the end of each term. Additionally, course unions are required to run an annual general meeting once a year. During this meeting, the “voting membership” can make decisions directly. So, while the CSCU is a “representative democracy” like the government of Canada, once a year, it gets to be a direct democracy. That's the AGM!

The general format of a resolution package like this is as follows:

- A few lines that start with “*Whereas*”. These lines are meant to provide a justification for the resolution
- A “*Be it resolved*” line. This is what, if the resolution passes, you are *commanding* the CSCU Executive Council to do.
- Possibly one or more “*Be it further resolved*” lines. These are extra commands

Also important to know is that this package includes ordinary and special resolutions. Ordinary resolutions require a majority of people to vote “yes” in order for them to pass. In our case, passing a bylaw is an ordinary resolution. Special resolutions have a higher bar to pass: 75% of all members need to vote “yes”. Changes to the constitution require special resolutions. Here's a breakdown of the resolutions in plain English:

- Resolution 1 seeks to **make lower-year students studying computer science who haven't yet or are otherwise unable to declare a major or minor “voting members” of the CSCU**. While everyone is welcome to attend our events, as it currently stands, the only people who can run for executive positions and vote in our AGM are students who have declared their major or minor to be CS.
- Resolution 2 seeks to **make it explicit within the CSCU constitution that our course union includes arts students who are majoring or minoring in CS**. BA students studying CS are already technically members of the CSCU as a consequence of the definition, but we want to make that explicit within the text, both as a bit of future-proofing and to make a stronger mandate for the CSCU to cater to the needs of both BSc and BA students.
- Resolution 3 seeks to **make students majoring or minoring in data science members of the CSCU**. DS students are *not* currently members of the CSCU (that is, DS students who aren't also majoring or minoring in CS, which is a smaller group but they exist nonetheless), so we're

inviting the membership to extend membership to data science students for next year. The immediate consequence of passing this resolution is that DS students will have an opportunity to vote in the upcoming election and next year's AGM. The CSCU will also be responsible to cater more to the needs of DS students on top of its commitments to CS students.

- Resolution 4 proposes to **change the name of the full name of the CSCU from “Computer Science Course Union” to “Computational Science Course Union”**. This resolution may be desirable if Resolution 3 passes, otherwise the CSCU Executive Council will likely move to a vote immediately and encourage general members to vote down the proposal.
- Resolution 5 proposes to **abolish the role of President on the CSCU Executive Council**. Traditionally, the president calls the shots in the CSCU, as they're usually the most senior executive and the name itself suggests they're more important than they are. Formally, the President has no more authority than any other executive on the council. We're proposing to rename the President to “Vice-President Internal” which better reflects what their actual responsibilities are, as well as putting the Secretary in charge of leading meetings, which fits better with their responsibilities. Because the SUO requires that course unions have a “president,” the new Vice-President Internal will be required to “sign as the president” as required by the SUO, even though officially there is no president.
- Resolution 6 **creates three new roles: Data Science Representative and Computer Science Representative**. As with resolution 4, this one only makes sense if Resolution 3 passes.
- Resolution 7 **creates one additional role: Graduate Student Representative**. There's a lot of discontent among graduate students with how the SUO and SUO student associations broadly don't engage with graduate students, and so we propose adding this role as a way to explicitly have someone represent the interests of graduate students within the CSCU.
- Resolution 8 proposes adopting Bylaw I. Bylaw I has been adopted by the CSCU Executive Council, but as it stands, the council may reverse that decision whenever it wants. If people decide to adopt a bylaw at the AGM, it may only be reversed or changed at another AGM—in other words, we're seriously held to account to follow it. Bylaw I **implements consensus democracy in the CSCU Executive Council** and provides a mechanism to establish sub-committees. Consensus democracy is a system where decisions are made when *everyone* on the council agrees. This ensures that if someone is elected to represent some particular interest in the CSCU, their voice must be heard.
- Resolution 9 proposes adopting Bylaw II. The same reasoning for adopting Bylaw I at the AGM applies here. Bylaw II **establishes a permanent subcommittee to work on BC Hacks, composed primarily of people who aren't also on the CSCU Executive Council**. The goal is to make sure work on BC Hacks is sustainable and uninterrupted by the annual election (which makes seeking sponsorships virtually impossible). Additionally, this will help to free up the CSCU Executive Council to focus on the many other projects we have for students.

Resolution 1 (Special)

2024-02-07.03 (1)

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Whereas the CSCU is an interest group for Computer Science students

Whereas first-year students studying computer science are conventionally considered to be Computer Science students

Be it resolved, That the first definition described in the “Definitions” section of the CSCU Constitution,

““Computer Science Students” – A student enrolled at the University of British Columbia Okanagan, registered in an academic program offered by the Faculty of Science, majoring or minoring in Computer Science.’

shall be amended such that the bolded parts be added:

““Computer Science Students” – A student enrolled at the University of British Columbia Okanagan, registered in an academic program offered by the Faculty of Science, majoring or minoring in Computer Science, **or a student who has not declared their major or minor who is registered for at least three credits of courses listed under a course code compatible with this definition**’

Resolution 2 (Special)

2024-02-07.03 (2)

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Whereas the CSCU is an interest group for Computer Science students

Whereas the CSCU’s definition of its membership does not clearly include both students studying computer science as a Bachelors of Science and Bachelors of Arts

Be it resolved, That the first definition described in the “Definitions” section of the CSCU Constitution,

““Computer Science Students” – A student enrolled at the University of British Columbia Okanagan, registered in an academic program offered by the Faculty of Science, majoring or minoring in Computer Science.’

shall be amended such that the bold parts be added:

““Computer Science Students” – A student enrolled at the University of British Columbia Okanagan, registered in an academic program offered by the Faculty of Science, **including students registered for either Bachelor of Science or Bachelor of Arts programs**, majoring or minoring in Computer Science’

Resolution 3 (Special)

2024-02-07.03 (3)

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Whereas there is high overlap between the Data Science and Computer Science programs at UBCO,

Be it resolved, That the first definition described in the CSCU Constitution,

“Computer Science Students” – A student enrolled at the University of British Columbia Okanagan, registered in an academic program offered by the Faculty of Science, majoring or minoring in Computer Science.’

shall be ammended such that the struck-through parts be removed and the bold parts be added:

“~~Computer Science Students~~ **CSCU General Members**” – A student enrolled at the University of British Columbia Okanagan, registered in an academic program offered by the Faculty of Science, majoring or minoring in Computer Science **or Data Science**’

Be it further resolved, that all instances of the phrase “Computer Science Students” in the CSCU constitution be replaced with the phrase “CSCU General Members”

Resolution 4 (Special)

2024-02-07.03 (4)

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Whereas if the general voting membership of the CSCU decides to include Data Science students in the definition “CSCU General Members” as described in Resolution 4, the name “Computer Science Course Union may no longer be appropriate.

Be it resolved, that the “Name” section of the CSCU Constitution,

“This Course Union shall be known as the Students’ Union Okanagan of University of British Columbia (SUO of UBC) Computer Science Course Union (henceforth CSCU)”

shall be ammended such that the struck-through parts be removed and the bold parts be added:

“This Course Union shall be known as the Students’ Union Okanagan of University of British Columbia (SUO of UBC) ~~Computer~~ **Computational** Science Course Union (henceforth CSCU)”

Resolution 5 (Special)

2024-02-07.03 (5)

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Whereas the title “President” confers undo authority to the person who occupys the role of President on the CSCU Executive Council,

Be it resolved, that all instances of the word “President,” except for in phrases referring to a “Vice President”, be replaced with the phrase “Vice President Internal”.

Be it further resolved, in the section “Executive Member Roles” of the CSCU Constitution,

“The President shall be responsible for:

- a. Preparing, drafting, and presenting the President’s report on their operations at the Course Union’s AGM;
- b. Act as the primary liaison between the Course Union and the Student Union and must be familiar with all SUO bylaws and policies;
- c. Submitting Expense Reimbursement Forms to the Membership Outreach Coordinator in absence of the Vice President Finance; and
- d. Leading council meetings
- e. Overseeing and delegating tasks to appropriate council members as necessary
- f. Act as a signing authority”

shall be ammended such that the struck-through parts be removed and the bold parts be added, renumerating other points as necessary:

“The President shall be responsible for:

- a. Preparing, drafting, and presenting the President’s report on their operations at the Course Union’s AGM;
- b. Act as the primary liaison between the Course Union, ~~and the Student Union,~~ **Student Union-affiliated student associations, and UBCO officials** and must be familiar with all SUO bylaws and policies;
- c. Submitting Expense Reimbursement Forms to the Membership Outreach Coordinator in absence of the Vice President Finance; and
- d. ~~Leading council meetings~~
- e. ~~Overseeing and delegating tasks to appropriate council members as necessary~~
- d. ~~Act as a signing authority~~
- d. Sign as ‘The President’ of the CSCU as required by the Student Union”**
- e. Act as a signing authority**

Be it further resolved, that in the section “Executive Member Roles” of the CSCU Constituion:

”The Secretary shall be responsible for

- a. The taking of minutes at Course Union meetings; and
- b. Organizing agendas for Course Union meetings”

shall be ammended such that the struck-through parts are removed and the bold parts are added:

”The Secretary shall be responsible for

- a. The taking of minutes at Course Union meetings; ~~and~~
- b. Organizing agendas for Course Union meetings
- c. **Leading Course Union meetings”**

Resolution 6 (Special)

2024-02-07.03 (6)

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Whereas the CSCU is a growing course union with an Executive Council that does not have many representatives from specific groups other than lower year students,

Be it resolved, that the part of the section “Executive Member Roles”,

“The Lower Year Representative shall be responsible for:

- a. Representing the interests of first and second year Computer Science Students on the council
- b. Serving as a correspondent to first and second year Computer Science Students”

shall be ammended such that it is followed by the following text:

“The Computer Science Representative shall be responsible for:

- c. Representing the interests of students majoring or minoring in Computer Science on the Executive Council
- d. Serving as a correspondent to students majoring or minoring in Computer Science”

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“The Data Science Representative shall be responsible for:

- e. Representing the interests of students majoring or minoring in Data Science on the Executive Council
- f. Serving as a correspondent to students majoring or minoring in Data Science”

Resolution 7 (Special)

2024-02-07.03 (7)

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Whereas the CSCU is a growing course union with an Executive Council that does not have many representatives from specific groups other than lower year students,

Be it resolved, that the part of the section “Executive Member Roles”,

“The Lower Year Representative shall be responsible for:

- g. Representing the interests of first and second year Computer Science Students on the council

- h. Serving as a correspondent to first and second year Computer Science Students”

shall be ammended such that it is followed by the following text:

“The Graduate Student Representative shall be responsible for:

- i. Representing the interests of CSCU General Members who are graduate students
- j. Serving as a correspondent to CSCU General Members who are graduate students”

Resolution 8 (Ordinary)

2024-02-07.03 (8)

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Be it resolved, that Bylaw I, titled “Governance”, be adopted as written with the authority of the CSCU General Members ([see linked document](#))

Resolution 9 (Ordinary)

2024-02-07.03 (9)

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Be it resolved, that Bylaw II, titled “BC Hacks Working Group”, be adopted as written with the authority of the CSCU General Members ([see linked document](#))